RESERVE BANK OF INDIA - DEPARTMENT OF REGULATION
Document Reference: RBI/2022-23/92 DOR.AUT.REC.No.27/24.01.041/2022-23
Publication Date: April 21, 2022

Master Direction - Credit Card and Debit Card - Issuance and Conduct Directions, 2022

Chapter I - Credit Card Governance:

1. Unsolicited Cards and Unsolicited Upgrades:

(a) Card-issuers shall not issue unsolicited credit cards or upgrade existing cards without explicit consent of the customer.

(b) If an unsolicited card is issued or activated without consent, the card-issuer shall reverse all charges immediately and pay a penalty of twice the value of charges to the recipient.

2. Closure of Credit Card:

(a) Any request for closure of a credit card shall be honored by the card-issuer within seven (7) working days, subject to payment of all dues by the cardholder.

(b) Cardholders must be provided multiple channels for closure: helpline, dedicated email, Interactive Voice Response (IVR), and online banking portal.

(c) Failure on the part of card-issuers to close the card within 7 working days shall result in a penalty of Rs. 500 per day of delay payable to the customer till closure.

3. Choice of Billing Cycle:

Cardholders shall be provided a one-time option to modify their credit card billing cycle as per their convenience, at least once during the lifetime of the credit card.